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HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION (sued and served as The Hope Program)

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA

COUNTY OF SAN JOAQUIN

BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI, Plaintiff, v. KATIE PALACIOS, Clinical Director, HOPE Program (Stockton, California), an individual; HOPE PSYCHOTHERAPY, INC., d/b/a HOPE PROGRAM, a California corporation; and DOES 1-10, inclusive, Defendants.	Case No.: STK-CV-UF-2026-0001032 **DEFENDANT HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION'S RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFF'S REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION, SET ONE** Complaint Filed: February 10, 2026 Trial Date: TBD

PROPOUNDING PARTY: Plaintiff BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI

RESPONDING PARTY: Defendant HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION

SET NO: ONE

Defendant HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION ("HOPE" or "Defendant" or "Responding Party") hereby

objects and responds to Plaintiff BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI's ("Propounding Party") Requests for Admission, Set One, as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

The following responses are made solely for the purpose of this pending action. Documents eventually produced in response to the Requests for Admission and any individual request therein, are subject to admissibility, as well as to any and all other objections on any grounds that would require the exclusion of any statement therein if the information were introduced in court. All objections and grounds for such objections are expressly reserved and may be interposed at the time of any motion or trial. These responses are based on discovery available as of the date hereof. Discovery is continuing, and these responses are accordingly subject to revision. Further discovery, independent investigation, and analysis may supply additional facts and add meaning to known facts, as well as establish entirely new factual conclusions and legal contentions, all of which may lead to additions, changes to, or variations from the information set forth herein. These responses are given without prejudice to Defendant's right to produce, respond, or rely on subsequently discovered information, facts, or documents. Defendant accordingly reserves the right to change the response herein as additional facts are ascertained, analysis is made, legal research is completed, and contentions are made. The responses contained herein are made in a good faith effort to comply with the provisions of the California Rules of Civil Procedure but are in no way deemed to prejudice Defendant with respect to further discovery, research, and analysis.

RESPONSES TO REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION, SET ONE

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 1:

Admit that HOPE provided sex-offender treatment services to PLAINTIFF continuously from on or about March 5, 2021 through the present.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 1

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term "continuously."

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit that Plaintiff's initial screening was conducted via teletherapy and he verbally consented to

HOPE opening paperwork on May 24, 2021.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 2:

Admit that, at all relevant times during the RELEVANT PERIOD, HOPE was a CASOMB-certified provider contracting with CDCR's Division of Adult Parole Operations (DAPO) to deliver sex-offender treatment under Penal Code section 3008 and 15 C.C.R. section 3574.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 2:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term "deliver."

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 3:

Admit that HOPE submitted treatment-status information concerning PLAINTIFF to CDCR at every CTM held during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 3:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "treatment-status information."

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 4:

Admit that, at every CTM held during the RELEVANT PERIOD concerning PLAINTIFF, HOPE recommended continued treatment for PLAINTIFF and did not recommend a treatment-completion determination.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 4:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "treatment-completion determination." Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Admit.

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REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 5:

Admit that, during the RELEVANT PERIOD, HOPE has not determined that any parolee enrolled in HOPE's SOMP at the STOCKTON FACILITY successfully completed sex-offender treatment prior to that parolee's discharge from parole.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 5:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "successfully completed" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 6:

Admit that HOPE's four-phase program structure (preparatory, core, maintenance, aftercare) treats the aftercare phase as mandatory for parolees while they remain on active parole supervision.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 6:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "mandatory", and "active".

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 7:

Admit that HOPE's policies and practices during the RELEVANT PERIOD did not permit any parolee to be deemed to have completed sex-offender treatment prior to that parolee's discharge from parole, regardless of the parolee's individual clinical progress, homework completion, risk score, or compliance.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 7:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "did not permit" and unintelligible as phrased.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 8:

Admit that HOPE did not modify its treatment-completion policies or practices for parolee participants in any material respect after the March 20, 2023 DWYER order.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 8:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "any material respect" and "DWYER order". Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that there is a "DWYER order." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 9:

Admit that HOPE did not modify its treatment-completion policies or practices for parolee participants in any material respect after the April 17, 2025 effective date of 15 C.C.R. section 3574(f)(1).

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 9:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and

ambiguous as to the terms "any material respect" and "treatment completion." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 10:

Admit that HOPE maintains in PLAINTIFF's clinical file a Treatment Completion Plan dated October 18, 2023, authored by a HOPE clinician identified as "Bernadette."

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 10:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the as to the phrase "Treatment Completion Plan."

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit that PLAINTIFF's clinical file includes an "Individualized Treatment Plan" dated October 18, 2023, authored by Bernadette Marie Tassone.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 11:

Admit that the Treatment Completion Plan referenced in Request for Admission No. 10 has never been presented to PLAINTIFF for his review, signature, acknowledgment, or input at any time from October 18, 2023 through the present.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 11:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the as to the phrase "Treatment Completion Plan." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party

objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Plaintiff was referred to HOPE by the California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation ("CDCR") for specialized sex offender assessment and treatment. CDCR requested that HOPE determine Plaintiff's current risk level by utilizing specific risk assessment tools and reporting the results back to CDCR in the Individualized Treatment Plan. HOPE does not know if CDCR presented the Individualized Treatment Plan to Plaintiff. Such documentation is the property of CDCR. Based on the foregoing, Responding Party can neither admit nor deny.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 12:

Admit that HOPE has not presented to PLAINTIFF, at any time during the RELEVANT PERIOD, any Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument administered to him.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 12:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the as to the terms "presented", "Mason-protocol progress review," "structured progress assessment," or "comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument".

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Responding Party has no knowledge of the meaning of "Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument" and, therefore, can neither admit nor deny this request.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 13:

Admit that HOPE's Executive Director of Clinical Training, Dr. Cristina Loree, testified under oath in DWYER on or before March 20, 2023 that HOPE requires continuous treatment for all parolee participants until parole discharge.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 13:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "DWYER order". Plaintiff has not provided a certified copy related to

any action identified as "DWYER". Nor has Plaintiff provided a transcript of any testimony by Dr. Cristina Loree.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Responding Party admits that Dr. Cristina Loree testified on or before March 20, 2023, at a hearing involving an individual named Dwyer. Responding Party, however, does not have knowledge of the substance of the testimony.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 14:

Admit that HOPE has been aware of the DWYER order since on or before March 20, 2023.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 14:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "DWYER order". Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that there is a "DWYER order." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 15:

Admit that, on or about August 2025, in a HOPE group session at the STOCKTON FACILITY that was video-recorded, PALACIOS stated, in substance, that HOPE "routinely loses client homework packets," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 15:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "group session." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not

reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 16:

Admit that HOPE has lost, misplaced, destroyed, or been unable to locate one or more homework packets submitted by PLAINTIFF during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 16:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "homework packets." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 17:

Admit that, on or about June 2024, during an individual session at the STOCKTON FACILITY, a HOPE clinician acting under the supervision and direction of PALACIOS told PLAINTIFF, in substance, that no homework completed by PLAINTIFF had been found in HOPE's records.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 17:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "a HOPE clinician acting under the supervision and direction of PALACIOS", and "in substance".

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Responding Party has no knowledge of the alleged statement made by the unidentified party and, therefore, can neither admit nor deny the request.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 18:

Admit that HOPE characterized PLAINTIFF as having "partially completed" homework packets in one or more FORM 3043 submissions, FORM 1502-DR submissions, or other COMMUNICATIONS to CDCR during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 18:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "homework packets." Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 19:

Admit that HOPE cannot, at present, produce a complete and accurate record of every homework packet submitted by PLAINTIFF to HOPE during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 19:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "homework packet."

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 20:

Admit the HOPE is compensated by CDCR/DAPO for SOMP services on a basis that includes

payments tied to the number of parolees enrolled and the number of sessions of CTMs delivered.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 20:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term "compensated." Responding Party also objects that this request seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit that HOPE is compensated to provide quality services, pursuant to California Law implemented in 2012 as part of the containment model, for treatment to parolees whose attendance is a requirement of their parole conditions.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 21:

Admit that HOPE does not receive any fee or payment from CDCR/DAPO upon a parolee's treatment-completion determination or discharge from HOPE's program.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 21:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "treatment-completion determination." Responding Party also objects that this request seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 22:

Admit that HOPE's revenue attributable to a parolee participant decreases when that parolee is discharged from HOPE's program.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 22:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "revenue attributable to a parolee participant." Responding Party also objects that this request seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 23:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM concerning PLAINTIFF held at a CDCR parole office in Stockton, PALACIOS stated, in substance, that PLAINTIFF was "disruptive," a "ringleader," that his behavior was "abhorrent," and that he was "often disrespectful," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 23:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "stated, in substance." Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 24:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM, PALACIOS characterized PLAINTIFF's respectful demeanor at that meeting as an "acting job," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 24

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "respectful demeanor." Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that "PALACIOS characterized PLAINTIFF's respectful demeanor at that meeting as an 'acting job,' or words to that effect", and that PLAINTIFF displayed "respectful demeanor at that meeting". Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 25:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM, PALACIOS stated, in substance, "because when you

start complaining then the other guys chime in," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 25:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "stated, in substance." Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 26:

Admit that HOPE was aware not later than February 2022 that PLAINTIFF held a Class A Commercial Driver's License (CDL).

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 26:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "was aware." Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that PLAINTIFF held a Class A Commercial Driver's License (CDL).

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 27:

Admit that, in or about February 2022, PLAINTIFF disclosed to HOPE clinician Pamela Akins that he was working for Keurig Dr. Pepper as a CLD driver.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 27:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term "disclosed." Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that PLAINTIFF was working for Keurig Dr. Pepper as a CLD driver.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 28:

Admit that HOPE was aware that PLAINTIFF's CDLL employment required flexible scheduling, the ability to travel outside the Stockton region, and the ability to accept long-haul assignments.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 28:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "was aware." Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that PLAINTIFF's CDLL employment required flexible scheduling, the ability to travel outside the Stockton region, and the ability to accept long-haul assignments. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 29:

Admit that, in or about January 2022, after PLAINTIFF missed a HOPE group session in connection with a long-haul assignment for United Road, PLAINTIFF's then-parole agent (Arestad) threatened to violate PLAINTIFF's parole based on the missed HOPE session.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 29:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "threatened to violate." Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that PLAINTIFF missed a HOPE group session in connection with a long-haul assignment for United Road, and/or that PLAINTIFF's then-parole agent (Arestad) threatened to violate PLAINTIFF's parole based on the missed HOPE session.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit that PLAINTIFF missed a HOPE group session in January 2022, however Responding Party has no knowledge of a long-haul assignment of the actions of PLAINTIFF's then-parole agent.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 30:

Admit that HOPE's continued recommendation of further treatment for PLAINTIFF, and HOPE's continued characterization of PLAINTIFF as "not completed," caused CDCR/DAPO to maintain GPS monitoring, curfew, and geographic restrictions on PLAINTIFF that limited his ability to accept long-haul CDL assignments.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 30:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague, ambiguous and unintelligible as to the phrase "continued characterization of PLAINTIFF as 'not completed,'" Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that HOPE's continued characterization of PLAINTIFF as "not completed," caused CDCR/DAPO to maintain GPS monitoring, curfew, and geographic restrictions on PLAINTIFF that limited his ability to accept long-haul CDL assignments. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound and conjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Responding Party cannot speculate as to the basis for actions by a third party and, on that basis, must deny the request.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 31:

Admit that 15 C.C.R. section 3574(f)(1), effective April 17, 2025, provides that "[t]reatment completion and parole discharge are legally separate decisions."

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 31:

Responding Party objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 32:

Admit that the CASOMB Maintenance and Aftercare Guidelines (September 2024) require that discharge planning begin at intake and that the final determination regarding whether an individual has "completed" treatment should never come as a surprise to the client.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 32:

Responding Party objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound and conjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 33:

Admit that Penal Code section 3008(d)(2) provides that the length of a parolee's period in a sex-offender management program shall be "not less than one year, up to the entire period of parole, as determined by the certified sex offender management professional in consultation with the parole officer and as approved by the court."

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 33:

Responding Party objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit that the language quoted is found in Penal Code section 3008(d)(2).

Dated: June 8, 2026

SIMS, LAWRENCE & BROGHAMMER

By: _____
CYNTHIA G. LAWRENCE
BRYAN L. MALONE
BLAZE VAN DINE
Attorneys for Defendants,
KATIE PALACIOS and
HOPE PROGRAM

VERIFICATION

Newanforbi v. Palacios

I, Drew Kingston, state and declare:

I am the Chief Clinical Officer of HOPE Program, A Licensed Clinical Social Worker Professional Corporation, a Defendant in the above-entitled matter, and I am authorized to execute this Verification on its behalf. I have read the foregoing Responses to Plaintiff's First Set of Requests for Admission and know the contents thereof. I am informed and believe, and on that ground, I allege the matters stated therein are true.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed at Drew Kingston, California, on June 8, 2026.

Drew Kingston, PhD

DREW KINGSTON

HOPE Verif to Rogs (NEWpal) (060826)

Final Audit Report 2026-06-08

Created:	2026-06-08
By:	Blaze Van Dine (blaze@sims-law.net)
Status:	Signed
Transaction ID:	CBJCHBCAABAAlPem0hHzy08gTbu4XCFUcw6O3aWHT0k7

"HOPE Verif to Rogs (NEWpal) (060826)" History

Document created by Blaze Van Dine (blaze@sims-law.net)
2026-06-08 - 8:07:15 PM GMT

Document emailed to Drew Kingston (dkingston@hopeprogram.biz) for signature
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Email viewed by Drew Kingston (dkingston@hopeprogram.biz)
2026-06-08 - 11:29:54 PM GMT

Document e-signed by Drew Kingston (dkingston@hopeprogram.biz)
Signature Date: 2026-06-08 - 11:30:18 PM GMT - Time Source: server - Signature Appearance Selected: IMAGE

Agreement completed.
2026-06-08 - 11:30:18 PM GMT

PROOF OF SERVICE

I, Kim Schmitt, certify and declare as follows:

I am over the age of 18 years, and not a party to this action. My business address is 1478 Stone Point Drive, Suite 450, Roseville, CA 95661. My business email is: kschmitt@sims-law.net. I am employed in the County of Placer where this service occurs.

On the date set forth below, following ordinary business practice, I served a true copy of the foregoing document(s) described as:

DEFENDANT HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION'S RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFF'S REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION, SET ONE

☐ (BY MAIL) I am readily familiar with my employer's normal business practice for collection and processing of correspondence for mailing with the U.S. Postal Service. Correspondence so collected and processed is deposited with the U.S. Postal Service that same day in the ordinary course of business. I placed for deposit in the United States Postal Service in a sealed envelope, with postage fully prepaid, to the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY PERSONAL SERVICE) I personally delivered the above document(s) by hand between 9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. to the office of the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY OVERNIGHT DELIVERY) I deposited in a box or other facility regularly maintained by Federal Express an express service carrier, or delivered to a courier or driver authorized by said express service carrier to receive such envelope(s) to be delivered by overnight delivery, with delivery fees paid or provided for, addressed to the person(s) on whom it is to be served below.

☒ (BY ELECTRONIC SERVICE) I transmitted via electronic service through electronic mail to the offices of the addressee(s) below as stated on the attached service list on this date before 5:00 p.m.

SEE ATTACHED SERVICE LIST

☒ (State) I certify and declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on: June 8, 2026

Kim Schmitt

SERVICE LIST

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